

4.2.28 Stream Processors

These refer to the Arithmetic and Logical Units (ALU) of the GPU which act on the shading instructions. These are called Stream Processors. In earlier GPUs (prior to the GeForce 8XXX series and the ATI 2XXX series), stream processors existed separately as Vertex Shaders and Pixel Shaders. Stream processors are completely programmable and can be used for either of the shading jobs. These can operate at a different clock speed from the other components of the GPU.

4.2.29 Texels

A TEXTure ELEMENT is the smallest unit of a texture image. The size of the final texture and the number of texels that are needed to create it are influenced by texture-filtering procedures.

4.2.30 Texture Filtering

A process to ensure a smooth transition between areas using the same texture but with different resolutions. Its role is similar to that of Anti-Aliasing to ensure smoother slanting lines. Oft-used texture filtering procedures include Bilinear, Trilinear, or Anisotropic Filtering.

4.2.31 Texture Mapping

This refers to the process of applying an image that represents the texture / surface of an object to the model of the object. The model usually consists of lines, and is called a wireframe.

4.2.32 TMU

Texture Mapping Units are those components that are responsible for correctly orienting texture units to objects in the scene.

4.2.33 Trilinear Filtering

When transitioning from one mipmap to another, the differences in them can be obvious. Trilinear filtering works similar to bilinear filtering, except it takes samples from both mipmaps to smoothen out the intervening edges.